

The Ultimate DIY Cookbook

Mastering Classics, Asian Street Food Favorites & Legendary Anime Dishes at Home

I. COLD CONFECTIONS & CREAMY TREATS

1. DIY No-Churn Rocky Road Ice Cream

DESSERT • FREEZING

Prep: 20 mins Freeze: 6+ hrs Yield: 1.5 Quarts

Ingredients:

- 1 can (14 oz) sweetened condensed milk
- ½ cup unsweetened cocoa powder
- 1 tsp vanilla extract + pinch of salt
- 2 cups heavy whipping cream (cold)
- 1 cup mini marshmallows
- 1 cup raw almonds (coarsely chopped)
- ½ cup dark chocolate chunks

Instructions:

1. **Toast Almonds:** Bake chopped almonds at 350°F (175°C) for 6–8 mins until fragrant. Cool completely.
2. **Base:** Whisk condensed milk, cocoa, vanilla, and salt until smooth.
3. **Whip & Fold:** Whip cold heavy cream to stiff peaks. Fold ⅓ cream into chocolate base, then gently fold back into remaining cream.
4. **Mix & Freeze:** Fold in cooled nuts, marshmallows, and chocolate chunks. Pour into 9x5 loaf pan and freeze 6 hours.

2. No-Churn Cookies 'N Cream Ice Cream

DESSERT • QUICK

Ingredients:

- 1 can (14 oz) sweetened condensed milk
- 2 cups heavy whipping cream (cold)
- 1 tsp vanilla extract
- 18 Oreo cookies (coarsely crushed)

Instructions:

1. Whisk condensed milk and vanilla extract in a medium bowl.
2. Whip heavy cream in a separate chilled bowl to stiff peaks.
3. Fold cream into condensed milk, stir in crushed Oreos, pour into a loaf pan, and freeze for 6 hours.

3. Cookies 'N Cream Shake

BEVERAGE

- **3 scoops** Vanilla or Cookies 'N Cream Ice Cream
- **½ cup** Whole milk
- **4 Oreos** (2 blended, 2 pulsed for crunch)

Method: Blend ice cream, milk, and 2 Oreos until smooth. Pulse remaining Oreos briefly for texture. Top with whipped cream.

4. Creamy Taro Slush

BOBA SHOP STYLE

- **½ cup** Steamed taro root (or 3 tbsp taro powder)
- **1.5 cups** Ice cubes
- **½ cup** Milk & 2 tbsp condensed milk

Method: Blend all ingredients in a high-speed blender until slushy. Serve over cooked boba pearls with a wide straw.

II. SAVORY MAINS & ICONIC SNACKS

5. Cooking Master Boy's Golden Fried Rice (黄金炒饭)

ANIME SPECIAL

Prep: 5 mins Cook: 4 mins Technique: Yolk Coating

Ingredients:

- 2 cups cold, day-old jasmine rice
- 3 large egg yolks (discard whites)
- 2 tbsp neutral oil or lard
- 1 green onion, finely chopped
- ½ tsp sea salt + ¼ tsp white pepper

Instructions:

1. **Pre-Coat Rice:** Break up cold rice in a bowl. Pour egg yolks over rice and mix thoroughly until every single grain is evenly coated and bright yellow.
2. **High Heat Wok:** Heat oil in a wok until smoking.
3. **Stir-Fry:** Toss in rice. Stir-fry constantly on high heat for 2–3 mins until yolk cooks directly onto the grains into golden pearls.
4. **Finish:** Toss in green onions, salt, and pepper. Serve hot!

Chef's Secret for Golden Fried Rice:

Do not scramble eggs in the pan first! Coating cold rice directly with raw yolks before cooking ensures each individual grain receives a glistening golden egg mantle that separates cleanly when wok-fried.

6. Authentic Sichuan Mapo Tofu (麻婆豆腐)

SPICY • SICHUAN

Ingredients:

- 14 oz medium-firm or soft tofu (cubed)
- ¼ lb minced pork or beef
- 2 tbsp Doubanjiang (chili bean paste)
- 1 tbsp douchi (fermented black beans)
- 2 cloves garlic + 1 tsp ginger (minced)
- 1 cup broth + 1 tbsp soy sauce
- 1 tbsp cornstarch + 2 tbsp cold water
- 1 tsp toasted Sichuan pepper powder

Instructions:

1. **Blanch:** Simmer tofu cubes in salted boiling water for 1 min; drain gently.
2. **Aromatics:** Brown ground meat in oil. Add garlic, ginger, Doubanjiang, and douchi; cook 1 min until oil turns red.
3. **Simmer:** Add broth, soy sauce, and tofu. Simmer for 3–5 mins.
4. **Thicken:** Stir in starch slurry until glossy. Top with Sichuan pepper powder and scallions.

7. Crispy Homemade Cheese Tots

SNACK • FRIED

Ingredients:

- 3 medium Russet potatoes (peeled)
- ¾ cup shredded Cheddar or Mozzarella
- 1 tbsp cornstarch + ½ tsp garlic powder
- Salt, pepper & oil for frying

Instructions:

1. Parboil potatoes 6–8 mins (partially cooked). Cool & shred.
2. Squeeze excess water. Toss with cheese, cornstarch & spices.
3. Form into cylinder tots. Fry at 350°F (175°C) for 3–4 mins.

III. BAKERY CLASSICS & FRIED DELIGHTS

8. Macao-Style Egg Tarts (Pastéis de Nata)

PASTRY • BAKED

Ingredients:

- 1 sheet pre-made puff pastry
- 3 large egg yolks
- ⅓ cup superfine sugar
- ½ cup heavy cream + ⅓ cup whole milk
- ½ tsp vanilla extract

Instructions:

1. Roll pastry into a log, cut 12 rounds, and press into a muffin tin.
2. Whisk milk, cream, sugar, and egg yolks until smooth; strain through a fine sieve.
3. Fill pastry cups ¾ full and bake at 425°F (220°C) for 15–18 mins until custard spots caramelize dark brown.

9. Slow-Cooker Dulce de Leche

1-INGREDIENT

Ingredient: 1 unopened can (14 oz) Sweetened Condensed Milk.

1. Remove paper label from can.
2. Place can in deep pot; submerge under 2 inches of water.
3. Simmer low for 3 hours (keep covered with water). Cool completely before opening!

10. Cinnamon Churros

STREET TREAT

Ingredients: 1 cup water, 2 tbsp butter, 1 cup flour, 1 egg, cinnamon sugar.

1. Boil water, butter & salt. Remove from heat, stir in flour. Beat in egg.
2. Pipe 4" star strips into 350°F oil. Fry 2 mins/side. Toss in cinnamon sugar.

11. Fresh Strawberry Shortcake

CLASSIC SWEET

Ingredients:

- 1 lb fresh strawberries (sliced) + 3 tbsp sugar
- 2 cups flour, 1 tbsp baking powder, 6 tbsp cold butter, ¾ cup buttermilk
- 1 cup heavy cream + 2 tbsp powdered sugar

Instructions:

1. Toss berries in sugar; let sit 30 mins to form syrup.
2. Mix biscuit dough, cut rounds, and bake at 425°F for 12–15 mins.
3. Split warm biscuits, layer with berries, and top with fresh whipped cream.

12. Moist Banana Cake with Cream Cheese Frosting

BAKING

Highlights: Mash 3 ripe bananas into a buttery cinnamon batter with sour cream. Bake in a 9x13 pan at 350°F for 30 mins. Top with fluffy whipped cream cheese and butter frosting.

IV. SPECIAL BAKERY SHOWCASE

13. DIY Fresh Mango Sponge Cake

SHOWSTOPPER • BAKERY STYLE

Prep: 45 mins Bake: 30 mins Yield: 8-inch Layer Cake

Ingredients:

- **Sponge Cake:**
 - 4 large eggs (separated)
 - $\frac{3}{4}$ cup (130g) granulated sugar (divided)
 - 1 cup (120g) cake flour (sifted)
 - $\frac{1}{4}$ cup (60ml) vegetable oil & 3 tbsp milk
 - 1 tsp vanilla extract + $\frac{1}{2}$ tsp cream of tartar
- **Filling & Topping:**
 - 3 large sweet ripe mangos (e.g., Honey/Ataulfo)
 - 1 cup fresh mango puree (blended smooth)
- **Whipped Cream Frosting:**
 - 2 cups (480ml) heavy whipping cream (cold)
 - 5 tbsp powdered sugar & 1 tsp vanilla

Instructions:

1. **Bake Sponge:** Whisk egg yolks with $\frac{1}{3}$ cup sugar, oil, milk, and vanilla. Fold in cake flour. In a separate bowl, whip egg whites with cream of tartar and remaining sugar to stiff peaks. Gently fold meringue into yolk batter in 3 additions. Pour into two 8-inch round pans and bake at 325°F (165°C) for 28–30 mins. Cool completely and split each layer horizontally.
2. **Prepare Fruit:** Dice 2 mangos into bite-sized cubes for filling. Thinly slice 1 mango for the top decoration.
3. **Make Frosting:** Beat cold heavy cream, powdered sugar, and vanilla until firm peaks form.
4. **Assemble Cake:** Place first cake layer down, brush lightly with a splash of milk or simple syrup, spread a layer of whipped cream, add a layer of diced fresh mango, and drizzle with mango puree. Repeat with remaining layers.
5. **Decorate & Chill:** Frost the outside with remaining cream. Arrange thin mango slices in overlapping concentric circles on top to create a blooming mango rose pattern. Chill for 2 hours before slicing.

Pro Tip for the Best Mango Cake:

Choose ripe Ataulfo or Honey mangos for their fragrant sweetness and fiber-free, silky texture. Brush your sponge layers with a light mango syrup (1 tbsp mango puree mixed with 2 tbsp warm water) to keep the cake extra moist and flavorful!